

From supplier spreadsheet to usable offer

A developer work sample for Reflex Sales Group

Please don't spend more than a day on this. AI tools are welcome.

Build a complete workflow that we can try ourselves, using the fictional files supplied.

The business request

Imagine this request came from someone on our operations team:

"We help suppliers sell surplus merchandise to retailers. Suppliers email us spreadsheets listing what is available, often called line sheets. Every file looks a little different. Before we can work with an offer, someone has to clean up the item codes, sizes, quantities and prices. We lose time doing that by hand, and a wrong quantity or price can lead to a bad offer."

"Could you make a small website where I upload a supplier spreadsheet, check what it means, sort out anything questionable, and save an offer I can come back to? I want to see what is actually available and download a clean file for our internal team."

What would make it useful

1. **I can use both sample formats.** Northstar lists one item and size per row. Harbor puts sizes across columns. I should not have to rearrange the spreadsheet first.
2. **I can trust what I am about to save.** Show the items, sizes, available pieces and supplier cost per piece. Make questionable rows understandable, let me correct or leave them out, and let me check them against the original sheet.
3. **I can see the result.** Show the available pieces and their total value at supplier cost. Keep the amount we pay the supplier separate from the reference retail price. Make clear what was left out and why.
4. **The work stays saved.** I can reopen the same offer link from another browser and see my corrections and decisions. A second offer stays separate. If a save fails or I try again, make the state clear and let me recover without silently doubling stock or overwriting earlier work.
5. **The download agrees with the screen.** Give me a clean CSV or Excel file with the available items, sizes, quantities, supplier unit costs and line values. One export format is enough; this is for internal use.

What to deliver

Questions are welcome

Email me at any point for clarification. I am happy to explain the business or resolve an ambiguity. Note important assumptions about quantities, prices or what gets included. Make uncertainty visible rather than inventing an answer.

Keep the scope focused

Support the two supplied layouts; the 5,000-row sample uses Northstar's layout. We may change values, add rows or reorder the same named columns. No new formats. Clear errors for unsupported files are enough.

No login, real data, Airtable, email sending, PDF/image extraction, buyer pricing, commissions or deal management is needed. Choose your tools, interface and architecture. Libraries, starters and AI are welcome. The app must process uploaded data and save real results.

Show how you checked your work

- **Speed:** With the deployed 5,000-row sample, measure the wait for review, save and export on first and repeat runs. Include setup and repeat steps. Locate the largest delay. Show comparable before/after evidence if you improve it, or explain why it is adequate. Preserve correct totals. No hidden speed threshold applies.
- **Failure and recovery:** Reproduce a failed save and retry. Show what the user sees and what was saved before and after. Explain how to repeat the failure; a local test environment is fine.
- **Data protection:** Test an invalid quantity or price sent directly to the backend, bypassing the screen. Show that it rejects the change and preserves the saved offer.

Send us a working handoff

- **Working app and saved-offer URLs**, usable without an account and available through the agreed review date.
- **Source code and submitted revision**, setup/storage instructions, and tests for important data rules and saved-work behavior.
- **A short handoff:** workflow and architecture, main decisions, storage, assumptions, evidence from the checks above, known gaps and ongoing hosting cost.
- **AI and reused code:** what you used and checked. No prompt transcript needed.

We will try the app ourselves and discuss a result, a failure and a small business-rule change with you. AI stays welcome. We care most about business judgment, a reliable working solution, and your ability to explain your decisions. Visual polish is secondary.